

# HOW SAFE IS YOUR FOOD?

This is Food Safety and Quality year. But is our food safe? A lowdown on how to check contamination.



## MILK

### Common adulterant: Water

Put a drop of milk on a polished vertical surface. If it stops or flows slowly, leaving a white trail, it's pure milk. Milk mixed with water will bead off immediately without a trace.

### Common adulterant: Urea

Take five ml of milk in a test-tube and add two drops of bromothymol blue solution. If it turns blue, there's urea in it.

## Honey

### Common adulterant: Water

A cotton wick dipped in pure honey burns when ignited. If adulterated with water, it simply won't, or at least create a crackling noise.



## ICE CREAM

### Common adulterant: Washing powder

Tempting, for sure, but to check the purity of your ice cream, pour some lemon juice on it. If little bubbles fizz, it contains washing powder.

## SUGAR & SALT

### Common adulterant: Chalk, powdered stone

Dissolve sugar in a glass of water; chalk or stone will settle down at the bottom. It's the same for salt.



## Ghee or Butter

### Common adulterant: Vanaspati

Take one teaspoon of ghee with an equal quantity of cleaning acid, a pinch of cane sugar and shake well. Crimson reveals vanaspati.



## Mustard seeds

### Common adulterant: Argemone seeds

Argemone seeds have a rough surface. Also, mustard seeds are yellow on the inside; argemone seeds are white.



## Coffee

### Common adulterant: Chicory

Sprinkle some coffee powder on a glass of water. Unadulterated coffee will float but chicory will sink within seconds and it will also leave behind a trail of colour due to a large amount of caramel.

## Green chillies

### Common adulterant: Malachite green

Take a small part of the sample and place it on a moistened white blotting paper. The impression of the colour on paper indicates the presence of malachite green.



## TEA

### Common adulterant: Used tea, coloured leaves, iron filings

Rub leaves on paper: artificial colour will stain it. Tea leaves sprinkled on wet filter paper will show pink or red spots; move a magnet through it and iron bits will stick.



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